

BEYOND THE TEXTBOOK · GUIDE 05

Google Sites and Wix

Drag-and-drop websites: launch in under an hour without code, and know when to move on to real code.

TIME NEEDED 30–60 minutes	LEVEL Absolute beginner
YOU NEED A Google account (Google Sites) or an email address (Wix)	COST Free plans (with limits)

WHAT YOU WILL BUILD

A simple, good-looking website for a class project, club or event, built by clicking and dragging, with a free web address you can share.

Which one should I use?

	Google Sites	Wix (free plan)
Website	sites.google.com	wix.com
Free address	<code>sites.google.com/view/your-name</code>	<code>your-username.wixsite.com/site-name</code>
Ads on your site	No	Yes, a Wix banner
Designs	A few clean themes	Hundreds of templates
Best for	Class projects, notice boards, sharing Google Docs, Forms and Slides	Portfolios, small shops and event pages that need a more designed look
Main limits	Few layout options; no custom code for the whole page; basic SEO	Wix branding; own domain needs a paid plan; hard to move the site elsewhere

BE CAREFUL

Check each service's sign-up rules. School Google accounts may only allow sharing inside the school. If you are under 18, ask a parent or teacher to help you set up accounts.

Part A: Google Sites

Step 1 Start a new site

1. Go to sites.google.com and sign in with your Google account.

2. Click **Blank site** (the big +), or open the **Template gallery** and choose a template such as **Portfolio** or **Event**.

Step 2 Name the site and add a header

1. Click **Untitled site** at the top left and type the site name (shown in the browser tab).
2. Click the big header text and type your page title, for example **Science Club 2026**.
3. Hover over the header and click **Change image** to upload your own picture or pick one from the gallery.

Step 3 Choose a theme

In the right-hand panel, open **Themes**. Pick a theme, then choose its colour and font style. Every page updates together.

Step 4 Add content

Use the **Insert** tab in the right-hand panel. Click an item, then drag it into place on the page.

Insert	Use it for
Text box	Headings and paragraphs
Images	Photos from your computer or Google Drive
Layouts	Ready-made blocks such as picture + text side by side
Embed	A web page, a map, or HTML code (for example a Formspree form)
Forms	A Google Form for registrations or feedback
YouTube, Docs, Slides, Sheets	Show videos and documents directly on the page
Button	A link to another page or website

Step 5 Add more pages

Open the **Pages** tab and click + at the bottom to add a page, such as **About**, **Events** or **Contact**. The menu updates automatically.

Step 6 Preview on phone and laptop

Click the **Preview** icon (an eye) at the top. Use the buttons at the bottom right to switch between phone, tablet and laptop views. Fix anything that looks crowded.

Step 7 Publish

1. Click **Publish** at the top right.
2. Type the web address ending, for example `science-club-2026`. Your address becomes `https://sites.google.com/view/science-club-2026`.

3. Choose who can view the site (anyone, or only people in your school), then click **Publish**.

TIP

Google Sites does not update the live site on its own. After each change, click **Publish** again.

Part B: Wix

Step 1 Create an account

Go to wix.com and click **Get Started**. Sign up with your email or a Google account.

Step 2 Choose how to start

Wix asks what kind of site you want (for example **Portfolio**). You can let Wix's AI builder create a first version, or choose **pick a template** and click **Edit** on a design you like. Templates give you more control and are better for learning.

Step 3 Edit in the Wix Editor

- **Change text:** click the text on the page and type.
- **Change an image:** click the image, then **Change Image**, and upload your own.
- **Add something new:** click **Add Elements** (the + on the left) and drag an element (text, image, button, gallery, form) onto the page.
- **Move things:** drag elements; use the guide lines to keep them aligned.

Step 4 Fix the mobile view

Click the **mobile** icon at the top of the editor. Wix creates a phone version automatically, but check it: resize text, hide large decorations, and make sure buttons are easy to tap.

Step 5 Add a contact form

Open **Add Elements** → **Contact & Forms** and drag a form onto the page. Submissions appear in your Wix dashboard, and Wix can email you each one.

Step 6 Save, preview and publish

1. Click **Save** often.
2. Click **Preview** to test the site like a visitor.
3. Click **Publish**. Your free address looks like `https://your-username.wixsite.com/site-name`.

From drag-and-drop to real code

Builders are perfect for launching fast. As a computer science student, the next step is to build the same site in HTML and CSS (Guide 01). You will understand exactly how every part works, own every line, add a database (Guide 03), and host it anywhere for free (Guide 04).

You want...	Choose
A page for an event by tomorrow	Google Sites or Wix
To share Google Docs, Forms and Slides in one place	Google Sites
A designed portfolio with no coding yet	Wix
To learn real web development and impress colleges	Your own HTML/CSS/JS (Guide 01)
To save and show data (guestbook, registrations)	Your own code + Supabase (Guide 03)

ASK AN AI HELPER (Claude, Gemini, Copilot or Antigravity)

“Suggest a page structure and short text for a Google Site for our school science club.”

“Write a friendly 'About us' paragraph for an event website for a 12th standard farewell.”

“What are the pros and cons of Google Sites and Wix for a student portfolio?”

“I built my page in Google Sites. Help me recreate the same layout in HTML and CSS.”

Safety and good practice

- Do not publish your home address, phone number, or personal photos of classmates without their permission.
- Use your own photos, or free images from sites such as unsplash.com and pexels.com. Do not copy images from Google Search.
- Before you publish, check who can see the site.

Final checklist

- ☐ My site has a clear title, a header image and a theme.
- ☐ Every page has useful content, with no leftover template text.
- ☐ I checked the phone view.
- ☐ I published the site and opened the live link on another device.
- ☐ No private information is on the site.

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